

Meeting 12

Reading: System Documentation

Why Read System Documentation?

- Understand how systems and APIs work
- Learn how to use features or connect to systems
- Crucial for developers, testers, and users
- Improves technical reading and comprehension

Types of Documentation

- API Docs: Explain how to interact with software via code
- User Manual: Guide for end-users
- Technical Specs: Describe architecture or system design

Example: API Documentation (REST)

- Endpoint: GET /users
 - Description: Retrieve a list of users
 - Parameters: page (optional)
 - Response: JSON array of user data
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- Task:
 - - Identify the HTTP method
 - - Note required/optional fields
 - - Read response format

Task and Discussion

- Task: Read a sample documentation and answer comprehension questions
- Group activity: Match sections of documentation with their purposes
- Discuss: Why is clear documentation critical for system maintenance?

Evaluating Documentation Quality

1. Indicators of good documentation:

- Clarity and simplicity
- Completeness and consistency
- Use of diagrams and examples

2. Versioning and update logs

- Common issues:
- Outdated content
- Ambiguous instructions